

Drawing with the shape class

As with the text object, you can create images dynamically in AS3. There are several different types of image you can create, including traditional movie clips and graphics. You can now also create a new type of image called a Sprite. Essentially, a Sprite is the same as a movie clip with the exception that it does not contain timeline functionality.

Sprites can be created by invoking the new Sprite Object Class and then adding properties to the object. The following steps will add a new square-shaped Sprite to the stage:

1. Add the following ActionScript to create a new Sprite labelled “myFirstSprite.”

```
• var myFirstSprite:Sprite = new Sprite();
• addChild(myFirstSprite);
```

2. Format the size, fill/outline color, and position of the Sprite:

```
• myFirstSprite.graphics.lineStyle(3,0xFF6600);
• myFirstSprite.graphics.beginFill(0xFF0000);
• myFirstSprite.graphics.drawRect(0,0,100,100);
• myFirstSprite.graphics.endFill();
```

3. Now you can test the movie and see your rectangle on the screen.
4. Of course, this being ActionScript you can now add interactivity to your new Sprite. The following ActionScript will apply a fade-in transition effect to your new Sprite.

```
• myFirstSprite.addEventListener(Event.ENTER_FRAME, fadeInSprite);
• myFirstSprite.alpha = 0;
• function fadeInSprite(event:Event)
• {
•   myFirstSprite.alpha += 0.01;
•   if(myFirstSprite.alpha >= 1)
•   {
•     myFirstSprite.removeEventListener(Event.ENTER_FRAME,
      fadeInSprite);
•   }
• }
```

You can do a lot with ActionScript constructed images. Working with all the different objects available to you in AS3, you have almost no limits to what you can create using Flash. 